

VISIBILITY IN THE AGE OF AI SEARCH

Search is no longer a list of links

2022

Since ChatGPT launched publicly in November 2022, AI composes the answer — and it decides which companies get mentioned. If it does not quote your content, you are invisible.

THE PROBLEM

Ranking first and going unseen

Zero-click search is rising: the answer is synthesized on the results surface and the user never visits the page it came from. The ranking still looks fine in the report — the visit and the brand mention do not follow it.

SEO, AEO, GEO

Three acronyms, one new goal

AEO asks: can a machine extract my answer. GEO asks: when a model composes a fresh answer from many sources, does mine make the cut and get credited. Neither of them replaces SEO — they build on it.

SEO	rank the page
AEO	be the answer
GEO	be cited in the answer

THE SIGNALS MOVED

What decides who gets quoted

Not a LinkedIn fad: the term GEO comes from a 2023 research paper, later presented at KDD 2024. The goal changed, so the signals that matter changed with it.

Structure	over keywords
Quotable facts	over persuasion
Freshness and clarity	over volume
AI crawler access	a precondition

IN PRACTICE

What we run on every site we own

The shape is the same everywhere and it is easy to copy: make the site machine-readable, deliberately welcome AI crawlers while fencing off private routes, and answer real questions directly.

A content map for models	llms.txt
AI bots welcomed on purpose	robots.txt
Structured data	FAQPage, Organization
The answer stated early	first paragraph



MICODE

We will check how you show up in AI answers

We build sites and products legible to both people and machines: structured data, llms.txt, a sane crawler policy, and content written to be quoted. We will help you get found in the answer, not just on the results page.

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